

Figure 5.2 Business requirements are often not as simple as they appear.

- Frequent Flyer members normally earn half a point per kilometer flown.
- Silver and Gold Frequent Flyer members earn extra points.
- Gold Frequent Flyer members are guaranteed a minimum number of points per trip.

There are still some areas you need to investigate further. Do members earn more if they fly in Premium Economy or Business class? And what is the Guaranteed Minimum Point Earnings if you fly in Premium Economy or Business?

But let's leave these questions for now and see how you can express the examples you have so far as executable requirements.

One of the core concepts behind BDD is the idea that you can express significant concrete examples in a form that's both readable for stakeholders and executable as part of your automated test suite. You'll write executable specifications in the native language of your users, and produce test results that report success or failure not in terms of classes and methods, but in terms of the features that the stakeholders requested. Stakeholders will be able to see their own words appear in the living documentation, which does wonders in increasing their confidence that you've understood their problems. This is what BDD tools like Cucumber, JBehave, and SpecFlow bring to the table.

When you automate your acceptance criteria using this sort of BDD tool, you express your examples in a slightly more structured form, often referred to as *scenarios*. Dan North defined a canonical form for these scenarios in the mid-2000s, built around a simple "Given ... When ... Then" structure, and this format has been widely adopted by BDD practitioners ever since.

You could write the first example we discussed earlier like this:

```
Scenario: Earning standard points from an Economy flight
Given the flying distance between Sydney and Melbourne is 878 km
And I am a standard Frequent Flyer member
When I fly from Sydney to Melbourne
Then I should earn 439 points
```